Reading and writing

2026-11-13 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9D(i)

3.9D(i): Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence. In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it. Today: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the information.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C

4.9D(i): Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence. In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Answer a why or how question using evidence from the book.

I Do

Book connection: Sort facts, illustrations and text features into a central idea with supporting details. Read a short, accessible scene from The Pumpkin Book. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the information.; Grade 4 answer a why or how question using evidence from the book..

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about The Pumpkin Book: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the information. Grade 4: Answer a why or how question using evidence from the book. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from The Pumpkin Book. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: The Pumpkin Book. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Sort facts, illustrations and text features into a central idea with supporting details.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the information. Grade 4: Answer a why or how question using evidence from the book. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Make a large-print pumpkin life-cycle accordion book with picture labels and one fact per panel.

8-9 AM read-aloud

The Pumpkin Book by Gail Gibbons. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-13 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D

3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. 3.3D: Compose and decompose a fraction a/b with a numerator greater than zero and less than or equal to b as a sum of parts 1/b. In plain English: Build and break apart a fraction as a sum of unit fractions. Today: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5B

4.5B: Represent problems using an input-output table and numerical expressions to generate a number pattern that follows a given rule representing the relationship of the values in the resulting sequence and their position in the sequence. In plain English: Use a rule, an input-output table and expressions to represent a number pattern. Today: Continue 2, 4, 6; then find output 7 for input 5 under add 2.

I Do

Book connection: Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces. Grade 3: Join three one-fourth pieces to make three fourths. Separate into two fourths and one fourth. Grade 4: Build 2, 4, 6 counters. Say the rule is add 2. Use an input-output mat to show input 3 gives output 5 under add 2.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations.

You Do

Grade 3: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts. Grade 4: Continue 2, 4, 6; then find output 7 for input 5 under add 2.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces.

Science

2026-11-13 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Book connection: Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page. Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Compare the same car on smooth board and felt; test a magnet near a paper clip; release a ball into a tray.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Fraction pieces, counters, puppets, flashlight, sealed lukewarm bottle, magnet, paper clips, felt, board. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page.

Social studies

2026-11-13 | Week 5 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14B

3.14B: Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources. In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event. Today: Compare two sources and support one claim.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3B

4.3B: Summarize the significant contributions of individuals such as William B. Travis, James Bowie, David Crockett, Juan N. Seguín, Plácido Benavides, José Francisco Ruiz, Antonio López de Santa Anna, Susanna Dickinson, and Enrique Esparza. In plain English: Explain how important individuals contributed to the Texas Revolution. Today: Use a source to explain an event or contribution.

I Do

Book connection: Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes. Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to The Pumpkin Book and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. Use pictures, maps, or artifacts-not a dense reading passage. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from The Pumpkin Book that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

The Pumpkin Book | Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes.